

Miners Entertain Arizona

Days Slow For Cohen

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

Andy Cohen is crossing the days off his calendar until the 1975 baseball season is finally completed.

The University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach has yet to win a Western Athletic Conference game with with six games remaining on the Miners schedule, Cohen continues to have hope of at least one conference triumph.

"I'll sure be glad when the season is over," sighed Cohen

as he worked his team through a workout Thursday in preparation for Friday's 1 p.m. game at Dudley Field against Arizona's Wildcats.

"I really thought that we would have a respectable year but once conference play started, I said 'Forget it.' "

Following last week's three losses to Arizona State, the Miner's WAC record remained with a goose egg in the win column while the number 12 is shown as defeats Overall, U.T. El Paso is 15-23.

As the Miners battle a losing effort since the ship has already submerged, Arizona must win all three games this weekend in El Paso and hope that the University of New Mexico can upset Arizona State at least once in their three-game slate.

ASU leads the Southern Division with a 12-0 record while Arizona holds a 9-3 mark, all three setbacks coming from the Sun Devils.

Even if Arizona finishes second in the division, it'll wind up in the WAC playoffs under the new NCAA ruling which allows the first and second place teams to participate in the post-season playoffs.

Arizona is currently paced by pitcher Steve Powers with a 10-2 record and a 1.84 earned run

average. Powers is also the team's leading hitter with a .400 batting average. His 46 runs batted in ranks third behind teammates Mike Gatlin (58) and Ron Hassey (53).

Six other Wildcats hold .322 averages or better while Arizona's batting average as a team is .333 compared to .262 for opponents. Arizona pitchers are allowing 4.12 earned runs per game but opposing hurlers are giving up 8.79 an outing.

One of the only bright spots on U.T. El Paso's team is centerfielder Joe Pennies. The senior right-hander holds a .336 average and leads the Miners in runs scored (24), hits (40) and stolen bases (6).

The next highest average comes from third baseman Glenn Villarreal at .281. Villarreal is the team star with 10 doubles and five home runs. As a team, U.T. El Paso is batting at a .259 pace compared to .297 for opponents.

"You know," said Cohen, "Maybe if we're lucky, we'll win one of these games."

"It's been a long year and I'll be happy when it ends."

Maybe a victory against Arizona or possibly against New Mexico next weekend would put a sweet topping on the sour desert the Miners have been tasting all season long.

Arizona

rs said.

Campbell, president of the Hockey League, denied a report a Toronto newspaper that the league-operated California Golden Francisco businessman Mel Swig completed.

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s Tiger-Cats have signed two onal Football League players, the football League Club announced e, a 6-foot, 180-pound defensive